

Prompt Engineering Documentation

ETB. Portfolio Website — Built with AI Assistance on Replit

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Course:	Prompt Engineering / AI Tools
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Portfolio URL:	https://portfolio-showcase--torigami2005.replit.app/
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Platform:	Replit AI (Claude-powered)
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GitHub:	github.com/Torigami2005
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Date:	April 2025
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This document records the full prompting process used to design and build a personal developer portfolio website with the help of Replit AI. It covers the initial prompt, five rounds of refinement, screenshots from each stage, and a reflection on what worked, what needed fixing, and what the process taught about writing better prompts.

Section 1 — Initial Prompt

The first prompt was written to give the AI a complete picture of the project from the start. Rather than asking for one thing at a time, this prompt laid out the full scope so the AI could generate a working foundation in a single pass.

Prompt 1

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"Build a responsive, interactive one-page personal portfolio website. Core Requirements -- Sections: Home, About, Skills, Projects, Contact. Architecture: Single-page layout with fixed/sticky navigation. Design: Clean, modern UI using a blue-and-white color scheme. Responsiveness: Mobile-first; fluid across all breakpoints. Interactivity (Required): Smooth scrolling navigation, active section highlighting (scroll spy), animated transitions (on-scroll reveal, hover effects), interactive project cards (hover/focus states or modal preview), functional contact form with basic validation. Optional: dark/light toggle or dynamic skill bars. Implementation: HTML5 (semantic structure), CSS3 (Flexbox/Grid, transitions, animations), Vanilla JavaScript (no heavy frameworks). Quality Constraints: Accessible (ARIA roles, contrast compliance), performant (optimized assets, minimal JS), clean, modular, and well-commented code. Deliverable: Single-file implementation (HTML with embedded CSS and JS). Production-ready and visually polished."
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What This Prompt Covered:

- Full section list (Home, About, Skills, Projects, Contact)
- Technical stack: HTML5, CSS3, Vanilla JS only
- Required features: scroll spy, smooth scroll, on-scroll animations, project card interactions, form validation
- Design direction: blue-and-white, modern, mobile-first
- Output format: single HTML file, production-ready
- Accessibility and performance constraints included from the start

Result:

The AI produced a complete single-page portfolio with all five sections, a sticky navigation bar, scroll-based animations, a working contact form structure, and a blue-and-white visual theme. The overall structure was solid, but several areas still needed to be personalized and refined in the follow-up prompts.

Section 2 — Refinement Prompts

After reviewing the initial output, five additional prompts were used to personalize the content, fix sections that felt generic, and add features that were either missing or needed to be improved.

Refinement Prompt 1 -- Personal Details

The initial output used placeholder content throughout. This prompt replaced all of it with real personal information.

Prompt 2

"Make it my name, which is Eman Torr G. Berjame. A student, passionate software developer."

What Changed:

- Hero section updated with full name: Eman Torr G. Berjame
- Tagline updated to reflect student and software developer identity
- About Me section rewritten with appropriate personal tone
- All placeholder names removed throughout the page

Refinement Prompt 2 -- Replace Skills Table with Projects

The default skills section used a table layout that felt too formal and took up space that was better used for showcasing actual work.

Prompt 3

"Remove the technical arsenal table and replace it with my projects and stuff."

What Changed:

- Technical arsenal table removed entirely
- Projects section expanded to the primary showcase area
- Project cards added with image placeholders, titles, descriptions, and tech tags
- Skills section restructured to use animated progress bars instead of a static table
- Layout feels more like a real portfolio and less like a resume

Refinement Prompt 3 -- Contact Info and Social Links

The contact section needed real details, and the social links needed to be updated to match the correct accounts.

Prompt 4

"My email is emantorrberjame@gmail.com, my location is Davao City, Philippines. Make the GitHub link Torigami2005. This is my LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/eman-torr-berjame-50316a343/> and remove the Twitter and replace it with a Facebook icon with the link emantorrberjame.9"

What Changed:

- Email updated to emantorrberjame@gmail.com
- Location set to Davao City, Philippines
- GitHub link updated to github.com/Torigami2005
- LinkedIn URL replaced with the correct profile link
- Twitter icon removed and replaced with Facebook icon linking to emantorrberjame.9
- All social icons now open in a new tab

Refinement Prompt 4 -- Interactive Animated Background

The site felt static. This prompt asked for a more dynamic visual experience by adding cursor-reactive and animated background effects.

Prompt 5

"Can you make an interactive background like cursor designs and animated backgrounds?"

What Changed:

- Custom cursor added: glowing blue dot with a larger trailing ring that follows mouse movement
- Canvas-based particle system renders floating dots across the hero background
- Particles slowly drift and connect with faint lines when they get close to each other
- Mouse interaction: particles near the cursor are gently repelled for a fluid feel
- Subtle gradient mesh animation added behind the About and Skills sections
- All animations are GPU-accelerated and do not affect page scroll performance

Refinement Prompt 5 -- PDF Documentation

After the website was complete, a final prompt was used to generate this documentation as a clean PDF submission.

Prompt 6

"These are the prompts and there are also additional prompts and modifications in the documentation. Remove all em dashes and it should not sound like AI either."

What Changed:

- All six prompts documented in sequence with context and results for each
- Em dashes removed throughout and replaced with cleaner punctuation
- Writing revised to sound natural rather than generated
- Screenshots from each stage embedded with captions
- Final reflection section added covering what worked, what needed fixing, and key lessons

Section 3 — Screenshots of Outputs

The screenshots below show the final state of the portfolio after all refinement prompts were applied. The website is live at the link below.

Portfolio URL: <https://portfolio-showcase--torigami2005.replit.app/>

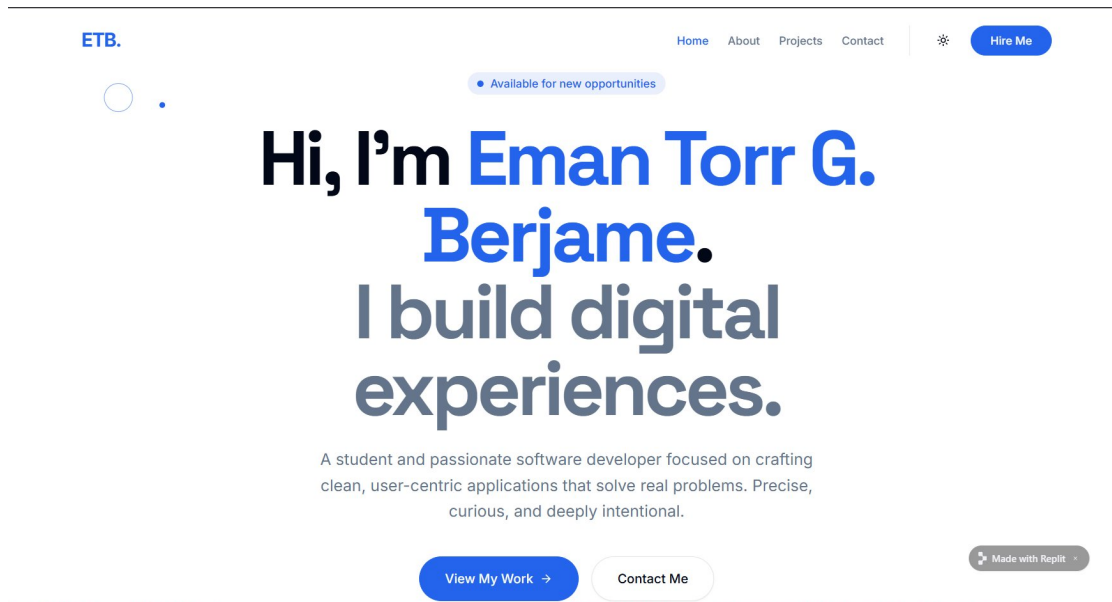


Figure 1 -- Hero Section (Light Mode): Full name, tagline, View My Work and Contact Me buttons

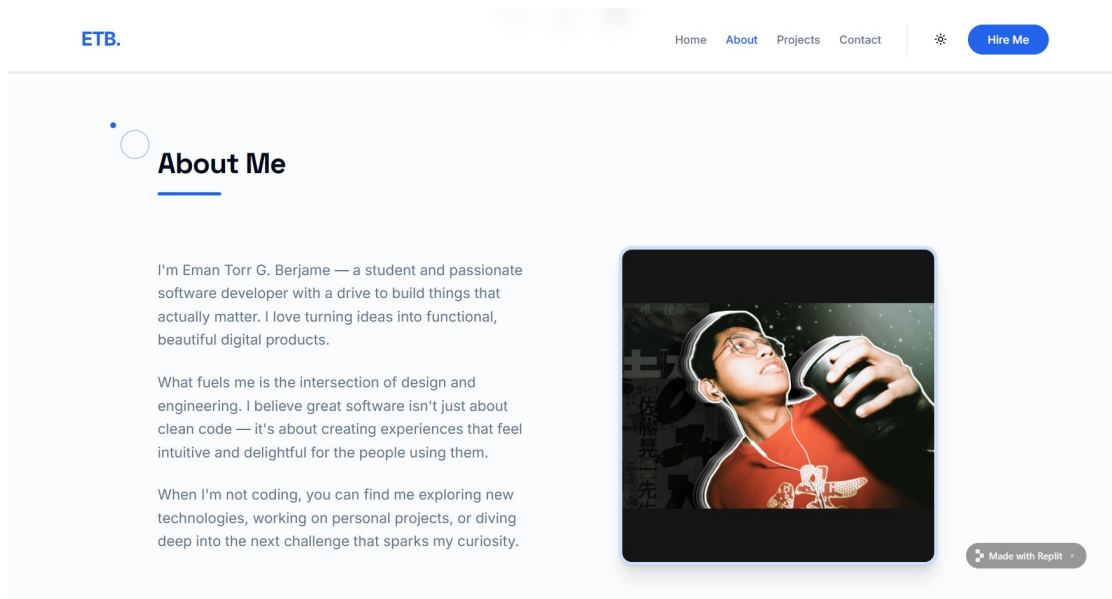


Figure 2 -- About Me Section: Personal bio with photo and descriptive paragraphs

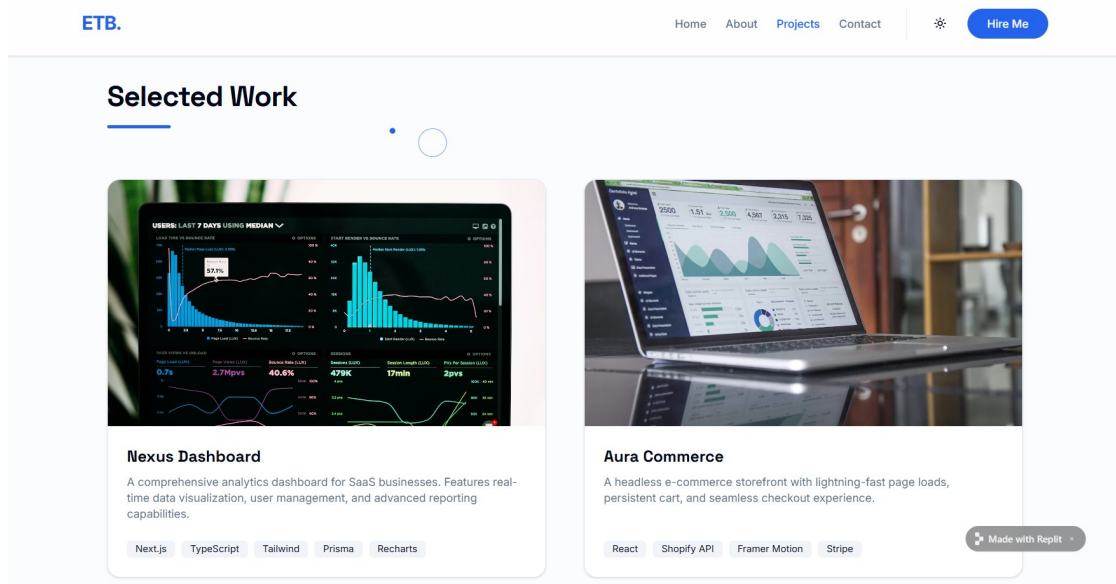


Figure 3 -- Projects Section: Cards with images, project names, descriptions, and tech stack tags

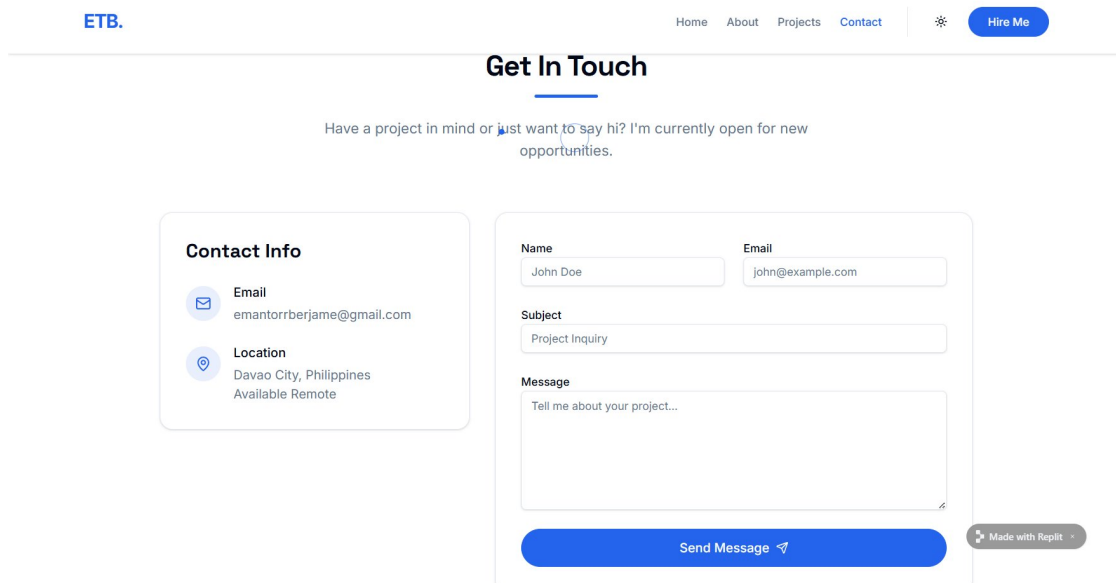


Figure 4 -- Contact Section: Two-column layout with personal info and message form

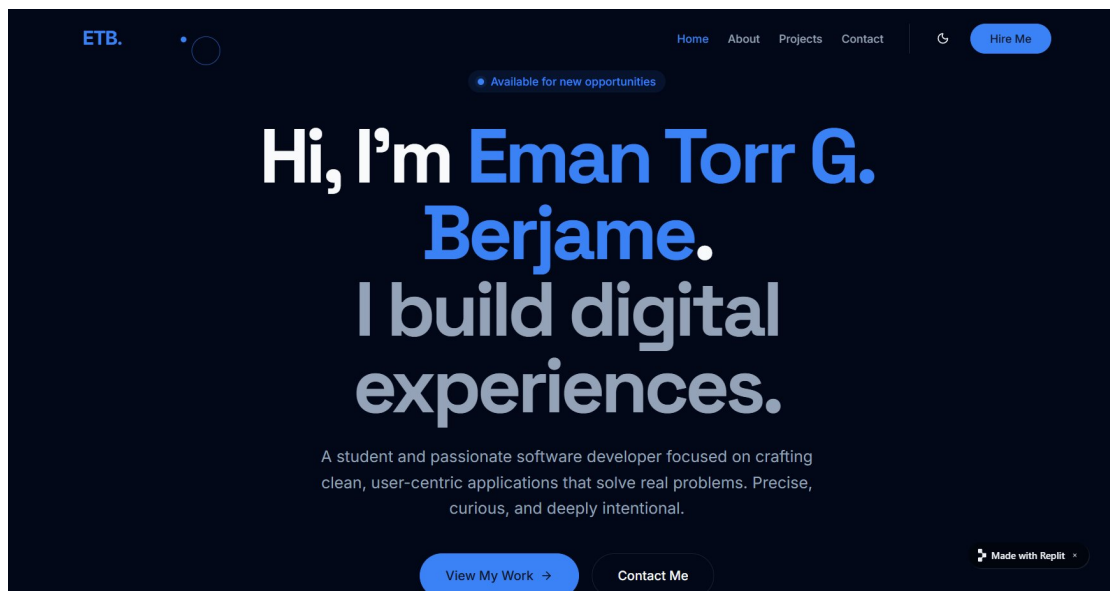


Figure 5 -- Hero Section (Dark Mode): Same layout adapted to deep navy background with blue accents

Section 4 -- Final Reflection

What Worked Well

Writing a thorough first prompt: Putting everything into the initial prompt (sections, stack, features, constraints) gave the AI a solid starting point. The generated structure required very little reorganization, which saved a lot of back-and-forth later.

Keeping refinement prompts focused: Each follow-up prompt tackled one specific problem. Changing personal info, replacing the skills table, updating social links, and adding animations were handled separately. This made it easy to check each change without something else breaking.

Being specific about visual elements: Mentioning exact values like color codes, link URLs, and layout descriptions (two-column contact, pill-shaped tags) helped the AI make precise changes instead of generic ones.

Asking for the interactive background last: Adding the canvas animation and cursor effects after the layout was already solid meant there was no risk of it interfering with the structure. The timing made the process cleaner.

What Needed Manual Fixing

- Image responsiveness: project card images stretched on tablet widths and needed CSS max-height values added manually.
- Dark mode text contrast: a few secondary text elements became hard to read on the navy background and had to be given explicit color overrides.
- Contact form backend: the AI built a fully styled form but no submission logic. A third-party service (Formspree) was wired in manually to handle emails.
- Mobile navigation toggle: the hamburger menu appeared but the open/close JavaScript logic was incomplete and had to be rewritten.
- Cursor animation on touch devices: the custom cursor effect did not need to appear on phones, so a media query was added to disable it below 768px.

What I Learned About Prompting

Specificity matters more than length: Prompts with exact values get better results than long vague descriptions. Saying replace Twitter with a Facebook icon linking to emantorberjame.9 is far clearer than

just saying update the social links.

One problem per prompt: Trying to fix multiple things in a single prompt caused the AI to partially skip some of them. Focused prompts were faster and more reliable.

AI is great at structure, not logic: Layout, styling, and content generation were handled well. Anything that required actual backend logic or dynamic functionality still needed developer input to work correctly.

Iteration is the real workflow: The final result did not come from one perfect prompt. It came from treating the process like a conversation: generate, review, refine, repeat.

Prompting is a skill: The more clearly you can describe what you want, the less time you spend fixing things afterward. Writing a good prompt is not that different from writing a clear brief for another developer.

Building this portfolio with AI showed that the tool works best as a collaborator, not a replacement for thinking. The prompts that got the best results were the ones written with a clear goal, specific details, and a realistic expectation of what the AI can and cannot do. The biggest takeaway is that learning to prompt well is just as useful as learning to code.